

Smash!!!

Tasks

Brainstorming game idea

Rough idea, connected with destruction + sketches



Development

Selecting a character mechanic



Spawning selected character in the level



Characters collision logic



Add timer to the level



Lose/win game scenes



3 characters sprites



"destroyed" version sprite for each character



animation for all characters' sprites



design UI, Main Menu and Credits



BG music and fighting sound



Implement lighting in all scenes



Polish mechanics and characters colliders



Destruction animation for each character



Notes

This week's topic at my university course "Game a Week" was "Destruction", which is a bit funny, cause we chose the topic using randomizer and "Destruction" was suggested by me;). Anyway, my first association with this theme appeared in my mind quite fast. I immediately remembered a classical game "Rock, Paper, Scissors" because it is very much connected with destruction, from my perspective. But I wanted to not just recreate a well-known game, but also add an additional layer to it to make the game more fun. Therefore, after the basic random selection of the character for each player, I decided to add a level, where the players follow each other: the goal of the player in a winning position is to collide with the other player, and the goal of the player in a losing position is to not get caught during a certain amount of seconds. This way a new twist is added to the "Rock, Paper, Scissors" game: if you chose a losing character, you still can win.

After establishing the general concept, I started to develop a game. The main goal for this week for me was to concentrate on the art part of the game (characters design, animations, etc.). However, I was scared that I would not manage to do this, since my concept required quite a lot of mechanics to be implemented. So, I tried to finish the mechanics implementation asap and then proceed with the art part.

Unfortunately, the technical part went not so smoothly. The main reason for that: I had objects that had "DontDestroyedOnLoad" component, because I needed these objects in several scenes. It caused a lot of bugs and errors, for instance, when a scene is opened, all the components on the inspector are not assigned and the error appears. I had to spend two days on fixing all these problems, searching for different approaches and reading the script again and again to find the cause of the issue. And even though it distracted me a lot from the art part, I still was motivated to give this game a strong, coherent art style and make characters unique and memorable.

To achieve this goal I started with a simple thing: I assigned to each character their own color, with which they are associated and which is used for their visualization in the game. Also, I made two versions of each character: normal one and destroyed one. After that I made an animation to all the sprites to make characters and game in general look more "alive".

Considering the animations, there was one issue: I wanted the characters to be animated in level as well, however, I haven't managed to. Because I couldn't use the idle animation that I already had in the main menu (this animation was a bit too intense for the actual level), and making a separate animation and assigning it to the player prefab (I have 1 prefab for all players and only the sprite changes) would bring back some bugs I had before. And due to the fact that those bugs took a lot of time and energy to fix, I didn't want to face them again, so I just skipped the characters' animations in the level.

In conclusion, I am happy with the result I achieved in just 3 days. I am satisfied with the art style and the game doesn't break completely (which is already a success). The main thing that I would change is that it would make sense to give the game to people to test it before the presentation in class. The fact that I didn't do that led to that I had a bad game balance: obstacles or the colliders of the players are too big, it is too difficult to not get caught by the other player, etc. All these aspects influence players' experience and it would be cool to fix and balance this. That is why I understand the importance of playtesting, especially for multiplayer games, even more now.

Screenshots

